Dear Quillstone Payments Hiring Team,

I am applying for the Machine Learning Engineer – Customer Support AI role. I have six years of experience in analytics and data science, including more than four years as a data scientist, and am now looking to develop further in machine learning engineering. The opportunity to build systems that help merchants and support agents is a compelling next step.

At Thistlebox, I built a LightGBM model to forecast weekly orders by recipe and region. By engineering calendar, price and menu-position features, I reduced forecast error from 23% to 14%, with an estimated 9% reduction in food waste. The workflow runs as a scheduled Vertex AI Workbench notebook, writing results to BigQuery for operations to use in Looker. I have also started writing pytest unit tests for the forecasting feature code and built a churn model scored weekly in BigQuery.

Alongside modelling, I write production SQL and maintain dbt models and scheduled workflows. I built a Streamlit testing calculator used by approximately 25 colleagues and wrote its Dockerfile; our data platform team handled deployment. My MSc in Statistics gave me a strong grounding in modelling uncertainty, while designing experiments and presenting results to leadership have taught me to connect technical work with operational decisions.

I would welcome the chance to bring this experience in Python, feature engineering and operational workflows to Quillstone's Customer Operations AI team, while developing my production engineering skills alongside its engineers and data scientists. Thank you for considering my application; I would be pleased to discuss the role and my experience.

Kind regards,
Tobias Mwangi-Hartley